

# Donahue loved being second this time

Tim Gebhardt  
Chronicle-Telegram

TOLEDO— Pat Donahue had to be wondering what it was about the Toledo Fieldhouse that seemed to bring out the best in Olmsted Falls' opponent.

For the third straight year and four out of the last five, Donahue's Bulldogs found themselves at the Regional semifinal level and when Bellevue threw in five three-pointers the first period and eventually extended its lead to 14 points, 34-20, to start the second half, Donahue had to thinking he was reliving his worst Toledo nightmares.

However, Falls bounced back to win, 51-50, in overtime and will play Benedictine Saturday at 3 p.m. for the title and a berth in the Final Four at Columbus. It was Olmsted Falls first win at the regional in five tries under Donahue.

"After four times being the first guy in here to talk to you guys (media), it sure is nice to be second," said Donahue, sipping on a victory soft drink and smiling for the first time in the Toledo Regional post-game interview room. "This is just a great feeling."

With his two key seniors — John Storey and Schaefer at his side for the post-game, Donahue finally got to taste victory at the "Sweet Sixteen" level after the bitter taste of defeat the past three trips. Schaefer and Storey were two of the key players in Falls' last two trips and they kept their teammates thinking positive when things looked hopeless. "Obviously all of the accolades

go to not only these two guys but the other ten in the lockerroom to allow me to be the second speaker instead of the first."

Schaefer led the way with 28 points, many coming on the very play Falls ran at the end to win. Storey did what a point guard is expected to do. He had five assists and only two turnovers. His pass into Schaefer led to the final winning basket.

"We don't like losing down here," said Schaefer. "We don't have as much talent as we had last year, but we played much, much better as a team. That's all you need is 12 guys giving it their all."

"When we got down by 14," said Storey. "I would be the first to tell you doubt crept in there. They were pounding us."

"But when he (Donahue) called time-out, he got in our face. We knew what we had to do. Get in the mental toughness and go right at them."

Falls stayed with its game plan and slowly but surely got itself back in the game, winning on Schaefer's spinning shot in the lane with just four seconds left in overtime.

"Once we had them on the ropes," said Storey. "We (Schaefer and Storey) talked about it. We knew we had a shot (at winning)."

This time, Donahue and Falls will make the trip back on Saturday for a shot at winning the Toledo Regional and representing the area in Columbus next week.

Donahue only hopes he's second when it comes to the interview part.

## FALLS

From B1

"That meant we had to go deep in the bench. All year long we've worn teams down and this was a good example of it."

That also meant that 6-9 Jim Kalembe would get fewer minutes of playing time in the second half.

"I don't know if our legs got tired or what," said Bellevue coach Lyle Falknor. "We were as cold in the second half as we were hot in the first. They got up closer on us and put on more pressure."

After hitting 8 of their first 13 shots, the Redmen finished with just 10 baskets in their last 38. They made seven 3-pointers in the first 16 minutes and none in the final two periods and overtime.

Without Kalembe in the game, Olmsted Falls kept pounding the ball inside to Schaefer, who responded with 16 second-half points to finish with 28 plus 14 rebounds.

Bellevue rarely got a double-team on Schaefer and the Redmen didn't get one on the game-winning play.

"We knew if we swung the ball, we could get it inside," said Donahue. "They overpiled the ball side and the ball reversal was nice. We reversed it in the first half, but we just stood around."

"In the first half we were passive. I didn't think we attacked or pressure them. We made the adjustments and made them shoot a little quicker."

Bellevue went long stretches with little or no offense.

After going up 34-20, the Redmen scored only one basket in the next 9 1/2 minutes—one field goal in 15 possessions.

Falls scored nine straight points to cut the margin to five points at 34-29 and then got it to two with 38 seconds left in the third.

Bellevue scored to end the third quarter, but Manzie Williams took a pass from Storey.

## Jacks run over

Associated Press

Brad Lauer scored at 15:12 of the third period to give the Cleveland Lumberjacks a 4-3 International Hockey League victory Thursday night over the host Phoenix Roadrunners, ending a two-game losing streak.

Lauer's goal came after Jock Callander had scored twice to tie the score.

The Roadrunners took a 3-1 lead on a pair of goals by Brad Smyth and one goal by Ted Crowley.

## Roadrunners

Dave McIlwain scored the first Cleveland goal.

Derek Wilkinson got the win in goal for the Lumberjacks, making 30 saves on 33 shots. J.C. Bergeron stopped 35 of 39 shots for the Roadrunners.

# Chagrin Falls moves into final

## Ex-Vermilion coach Phillips leads Tigers past Miami East

Rusty Miller  
Associated Press

COLUMBUS — Former Vermilion girls basketball coach Frank Phillips was speaking for Chagrin Falls, but he might as well have been representing all eight teams that will play for state championships Saturday in the 22nd girls state high school basketball tournament.

"We're very humbled to be playing on the biggest weekend of the year in girls basketball," he said. "It's an extraordinary feeling."

Fourth-ranked Chagrin Falls (26-1) penciled its name into the Division III finals with a 58-52 victory over Casstown Miami East. In Saturday's 2 p.m. championship, the Tigers will meet third-ranked Wauseon (26-0), which set a record for margin of victory in any Division III game by beating Utica 57-33.

In Thursday's other semifinals, Kallida (25-1) edged New Riegel 48-45 and Fort Loramie (26-1) tripped Berlin Hiland 62-50. They will meet in the Division IV championship game Saturday at 11 a.m.

Trish Kruse controlled the outside with 16 points and seven

## GIRLS STATE BASKETBALL TOURNAMENT

assists and Kelly Haase and Katie Carson dominated inside with 14 points apiece for the Tigers.

Patience was the key word for Chagrin Falls, which frequently made a half-dozen passes before attacking the basket.

Carson, an honorable mention all-state selection, added 14 rebounds, while Haase, a second-team All-Ohioan, had eight as the Tigers held a 38-32 advantage on the boards.

"The rebounding was a huge advantage for us," Phillips said. "Plus we did a lot of the little things early in the game that helped us keep our composure."

Jessie Roeth scored 19 points and second-team All-Ohioan Angle Benham had 11 points for Miami East (23-3), unranked and making its first appearance at the state tournament.

Wauseon.....57  
Utica.....33

The Indians continued a Cinderella season. Prior to this year, a Wauseon girls team had never won a district tournament game, let alone one at the regional or state level.

First-team All-Ohioan Katie Griggs led the way with 14 points, while Kelly Buegel had 12 and Amberly Naas scored 10 — including a 45-foot 3-point heave to end the first quarter.

No. 2-ranked Utica, which lost for the first time after 26 victories, got 10 points from Christina Bullock.

Utica became the first girls team to not shoot a free throw in a final-four game.

The 24-point margin eclipsed the previous mark in Sherwood Fairview's 57-34 semifinal victory over Lisbon Anderson two years ago.

Fort Loramie.....62  
Berlin Hiland.....50

Second-team All-Ohioan Mandy Winner scored 21 points as Fort Loramie used its muscle inside to advance.

The Redskins continually went inside for points, hitting 55 percent of their shots from the field (23-of-42). Even when they missed, they dominated the boards, 32-19, including 14 offensive rebounds.

Erica Hostettler led Berlin Hiland (24-3), No.9 in the last reg-

ular-season Associated Press poll, with 19 points. Honorable mention All-Ohioan Julie Mast chipped in with 12 points.

Kallida.....48  
New Riegel.....45

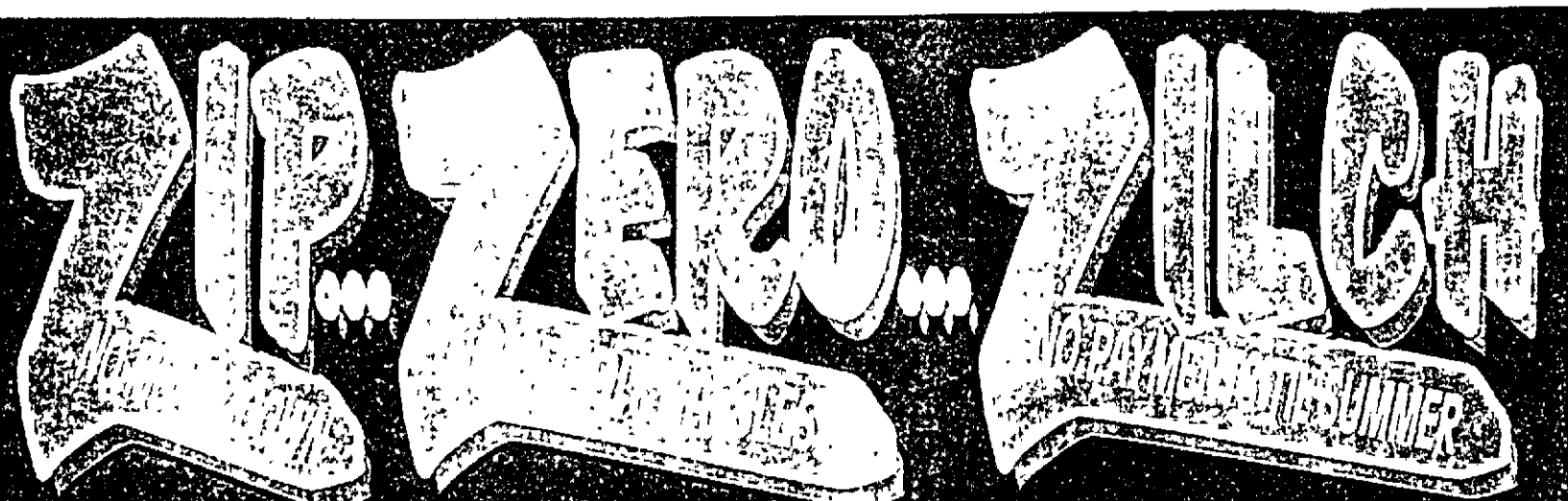
In the only suspenseful game of the day, Amy Birkemeler scored on a three-point play with 46.7 seconds left and Heather Haselman came off the bench to score 16 points and block the potential tying shot to seal Kallida's win.

Hitting double figures for New Riegel (21-5) were Chesleigh Underwood, with 16 points, second-team All-Ohioan Rachel Faeth with 15 and Amanda Lafontaine with 11.

New Riegel (21-5), which had trailed by as many as 15 points in the second quarter, took a 43-42 lead on Lafontaine's shot with 1:18 remaining.

With 51.5 seconds left, Haselman, who also had 14 rebounds, hit the second of two foul shots to square things at 43.

On the ensuing inbound play, second-team All-Ohioan Francine Miller stole a pass and then fired an assist to Birkemeler. She hit the bucket while being fouled by Underwood, then hit the free throw for a 46-43 lead.



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